

**BEFORE THE
FEDERAL ENERGY REGULATORY COMMISSION**

**Interconnection of Large Loads to the)
Interstate Transmission System)**

Docket No. RM26-4-000

INITIAL COMMENTS OF OPENAI INC.

OpenAI Inc. (“OpenAI”) respectfully submits these initial comments in response to the Commission’s October 27, 2025 Notice in the above-captioned proceeding inviting comments on the U.S. Department of Energy’s (“DOE’s”) Advanced Notice of Proposed Rulemaking addressing the timely and orderly interconnection of large loads (“DOE ANOPR”). OpenAI appreciates this opportunity to provide initial comments addressing issues affecting the interconnection of large loads to the interstate transmission system at this critical juncture in our nation’s history. In 2024, China brought online more than half of all new electricity capacity in the world, part of its national strategy to overtake the American advantage in artificial intelligence by 2030; America, by contrast, accounted for just 12 percent. For our country to maintain its leadership in AI, it must also lead in building the energy infrastructure that powers AI and close this “electron gap” with China. The Commission’s invitation to comment is an important step toward getting there.

OpenAI supports the DOE’s and the Commission’s initiative to promote speed, reliability and clarity in the interconnection of large loads to the interstate transmission system. The comments below highlight a few practicable mechanisms that can support this initiative and that are consistent with the DOE ANOPR. These mechanisms should help DOE and the Commission achieve the goal of expeditiously interconnecting new large loads, such as data centers that enable artificial intelligence (“AI”) research.

INITIAL COMMENTS

1. Consistent with Principle 4, nationally-important projects designated by DOE should be expedited.

OpenAI supports an approach that allows the DOE to identify and provide a “national-interest” designation for loads above 250 MW that have clear national interest or security, economic imperative or competitiveness, or critical-infrastructure value. Transmission providers should then be required to expedite the interconnection of these designated projects through a fast track process.

2. Consistent with Principle 7 of the DOE ANOPR, large loads that agree to be curtailable should be expedited.

OpenAI supports an optional curtailable-load pathway where full or partial curtailment obligations of the large loads allow the transmission provider to expedite the interconnection request. This will distinguish ready, flexible loads with reduced impacts on the electric transmission system and enable available transmission capacity to be put to beneficial use, thereby enhancing system efficiency.

Apart from improving utilization of available transmission system capacity, load curtailment commitments also can benefit system reliability when supply is not adequate to meet system demand. Large loads that agree to curtail demand when called on by system operators for a predetermined number of hours should be given interconnection priority over inflexible loads.

3. Consistent with Principles 3 and 5, hybrid facilities should be allowed to expedite their interconnection by performing net-impact studies outside the normal interconnection queue process.

OpenAI supports a clear pathway for load paired with on-site or behind-the-meter generation to be evaluated on a net-impact basis to capture real system effects and reduce study burdens and duration. This will allow transmission providers to prioritize and expedite the most rational, cost-effective, and grid-complimentary projects.

4. Consistent with Principle 4, commercially-ready loads should be prioritized over speculative ones.

OpenAI supports standardized readiness criteria that classify large loads based on strict metrics for commercial readiness, end user alignment, site and engineering maturity, and near-term operational timelines. This will help all parties—transmission providers, end users, utilities, and regulators—to maximize efficiency by directing scarce resources towards vetted, viable projects.

For large load projects that meet the readiness criteria and have secured valid end user agreements but subsequently withdraw for reasons beyond their control, withdrawal penalties should be reduced. Speculative loads that withdraw without end user offtake agreements should remain subject to full withdrawal penalties.

6. Consistent with Principles 8 and 9, commercially-ready loads should be allowed to fund and self-build network upgrades when that will expedite the interconnection.

OpenAI supports allowing, subject to appropriate protections, commercially-ready large loads to fund and voluntarily construct required network upgrades identified by the transmission provider, when doing so will accelerate the interconnection. This approach could be particularly appropriate for large loads paired with on-site or hybrid generation.

CONCLUSION

OpenAI supports the DOE's and the Commission's large load interconnection initiatives and encourages stakeholders to promote simple and actionable steps to expedite the interconnection of ready, high-value large loads, including loads that will help maintain U.S. dominance in AI research. These initiatives will unlock American energy, sustain the American advantage in continued innovation with AI, and help ensure that the benefits of AI are accessible

to all Americans. OpenAI appreciates the DOE's and the Commission's leadership on these critical issues and looks forward to continued engagement as the rulemaking develops.

Respectfully submitted,

/s/

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